

Snippets

User forum on 3D printing concludes successfully

Stratasys, an applied additive technology solutions provider, recently concluded its first user conference on 3D printing technology. This conference provided a platform to advocate printing technology where key industry players and end-users exchanged insights on the latest 3D printing trends, applications and best practices to succeed in today's globally competitive manufacturing ecosystem.

SignEasy launches Aadhaar-based electronic signatures

SignEasy, an e-signature software provider for professionals and SMBs, has launched its Aadhaar-compliant eSign solution with a fully integrated fill-and-sign document workflow. With over 140,000 customers across 180 countries, SignEasy aims to help businesses across India eliminate their dependence on paper-based processes while supporting the Indian government's vision for Digital India.

Thales acquires Gemalto

Aerospace and defence company Thales is buying chipmaker Gemalto in a deal worth 4.8 billion euros (\$5.6 billion). The agreement came just two days after Gemalto had rejected an earlier bid by rival Atos to strengthen in the emerging field of digital security as well as the Internet of Things (IoT).

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Calendar of Forthcoming Electronics Fairs/Exhibitions/Seminars/Events

Name, Date and Venue	Topics	Contact address for details
Automation Expo 2018 Aug. 29-Sept. 1, 2018 Bombay Convention & Exhibition Center, Goregaon East, Mumbai	13th international exhibition & conference on automation	IED Communications Ltd Website: www.automationindiaexpo.com
IFA Berlin Aug. 31-Sept. 5, 2018 Berlin Exhibition Center (Expo Center City), Germany	International trade show for consumer electronics and home appliances	Website: http://b2b-ifa-berlin.com
SEMICON Taiwan, 2018 Taipei, Taiwan September 12-14, 2018	Premier event in Taiwan for microelectronics manufacturing	Website: www.semicon.taiwan.org/en
TAITRONICS Oct. 9-12, 2018 Taipei Nangang Exhibition Center	International electronics show	Website: https://www.taitronics.tw
Open Source India October 11-13, 2018 Bengaluru	Platform for the open source community to share what's new and exciting in open source languages, tools and techniques	Website: https://opensourceindia.in/osidays
GITECH October 14-18, 2018 Dubai World Trade Centre	Showcase of the world's most advanced technologies	Website: https://www.gitex.com/
electronica Munich Nov. 13-16, 2018 Munich, Germany	International trade fair for electronic components, systems and applications	Website: www.electronica.de

Since this information is subject to change, all those interested are advised to ascertain the details from the organisers before making any commitment.

ELCINA's pre-budget recommendations

ELCINA president Pankaj Gulati has urged the Indian government to use goods and services tax (GST) as a tool to benefit the manufacturers bound by IT Agreement. Gulati has also sought imposition of duty on those technology and telecom products which fall outside the purview of the Information Technology Agreement (ITA-1) signed by India in 1996-97. According to him, such a move would boost domestic IT

and telecom equipment manufacturing in the country.

MediaTek announces smartphone design training

MediaTek has launched its second Smartphone Design Training Program in collaboration with India's Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY). The programme prepares design engineers and talented individuals in the mobile industry with tools,

insights and expertise necessary for a successful India smartphone industry. Programme details are available on <http://i.mediatek.com/makeinindia-sdp2018>.

In yet another development, MediaTek has partnered with Google to improve the performance of entry-level smartphones. Its MT6739, MT6737 and MT6580 system-on-chips (SoCs), among others, now have board support packages available to run Google's Android Oreo (Go edition). The partnership between the two companies aims to ensure a quality Android smartphone experience that is both secure and affordable for devices with 512MB to 1GB of memory.

Renesas announces winners of embedded design contest

Renesas has announced the winners of its *GRPEACH Embedded Design Contest 2017* in ASEAN. The contest encouraged students, hobbyists and professional engineers to build innovative IoT designs using the Gadget Renesas (GR) board.

Renesas invited the top ten contestants (six contestants from Vietnam, three from Singapore and one from Thailand) for a live project demonstration and announced the winners during the grand finale held in Ho Chi Minh City, Vietnam. An autonomous robot for indoor surveillance and monitoring, created by Trong Nghia Nguyen from HCMC University of Technology Vietnam, won the first prize.

Vignan University sets up CoE using Keysight products

Vignan University, Andhra Pradesh, has established an RF and wireless Centre of Excellence using Keysight Technologies' state-of-the-art equipment for system-level design and measurement of wireless technologies.

In yet another development, Keysight Technologies has made most of its products and solutions available on the Indian government's eMarket place (GeM) (<https://gem.gov.in/>). GeM was created to enhance transparency, efficiency and speed in public procurement. It provides e-bidding, reverse e-auction and demand aggregation facilities to help government users get the best value for their investment.